

Joe Lohr

Senior Laravel Engineer building compliance software and AI tools for car dealerships
Island Lake, Illinois

emailme@joelohr.com

I've been building websites and web apps for 15 years. Right now I'm the only developer at Automotive Risk Management Partners, where I build and run the company's multi-tenant Laravel platform that car dealerships use for compliance, including an AI assistant that answers questions from each dealership's own records. I work directly with our consultants, leadership and dealerships, from the first requirements meeting to demos, docs and support tickets.

Experience

Automotive Risk Management Partners Dec 2022 to Present
Laravel Web App Developer

- Sole developer of the company's compliance platform for car dealerships, a multi-database, multi-tenant Laravel app built on stancl/tenancy. I handle the architecture, security hardening, deployment and support.
- Built the compliance features dealerships use for the FTC Safeguards Rule and other requirements.
- Work directly with compliance consultants, leadership and dealerships: I gather requirements in meetings, demo new features to consultants, write the docs and answer help desk tickets myself.
- Met with a dealership that wanted to track remediation of audit violations, planned the feature with them and shipped it. Dealerships use it today.
- Designed a five-level role hierarchy: admin, consultant, owner, manager and employee.
- Built a tool-using AI compliance assistant with tenant-scoped authorization, so its answers only draw on data the user can access.
- Built an iOS audit app that consultants use at dealerships to record audits and photos, even offline. It syncs to the platform through a Laravel API and cut a typical audit from 1–2 hours to 20–30 minutes.
- Diagnosed why autorisknow.com was missing from AI-generated answers, then shipped server-side rendering, sitemap fixes and structured data.
- Also built and run the marketing site, a help desk, a sales CRM, courses and quizzes, PDF reports and third-party integrations.

TurnKey Digital Mar 2011 to Dec 2022
WordPress Developer

- Built custom WordPress sites for local businesses on a team of five developers and designers.
- Met regularly with prospective and current clients, online and in person.
- Shot product and location photos and video for clients.

Projects

ARMP compliance dashboard Laravel, stancl/tenancy, Inertia, Vue, TypeScript
Multi-tenant compliance platform for car dealerships, with a separate database per dealership, five role levels, courses and quizzes, vendor and audit forms, remediation tracking for audit violations, PDF reports, and an AI assistant that answers compliance questions from tenant-scoped data.

ARMP help desk Laravel, Laravel MCP, Inertia, Vue, TypeScript
Support desk for tickets dealerships open from inside the dashboard. The two apps never read each other's database; they trade signed, retry-safe events in both directions. An MCP server lets staff work tickets from Claude Code, which reads the conversation, checks the dashboard's docs, and drafts a reply that goes out under the staff member's name once they approve it.

ARMP Audit iOS app Swift, SwiftUI, SwiftData, Laravel

Field app consultants use to record OSHA, body shop, GLBA and deal jacket audits at the dealership, with photos. It works offline, queues changes, and syncs to the compliance dashboard through a Laravel API. A typical audit went from 1–2 hours to 20–30 minutes.

Self-hosted error tracker Laravel, Horizon, React, TypeScript, shadcn/ui

Accepts errors in Sentry's envelope format, so apps already using a Sentry SDK can point at it without code changes. Repeat errors are grouped into issues by a SHA-256 fingerprint.

autorisknow.com Laravel, Livewire, Claude API

ARMP's marketing site, with server-side rendering and structured data for AI search, plus AI tools that draft meta descriptions, keywords and other SEO copy.

ARMP CRM Laravel, Inertia, Vue, TypeScript

Sales CRM for dealership contacts and email campaigns, with AI help for drafting emails and call notes.

Case study

A tenant-scoped AI compliance assistant

Problem	Dealership staff ask compliance questions whose answers depend on their own dealership's records, like "Where are we at with employees completing their courses, and who hasn't finished yet?" A generic chatbot can't see those records, and one that could see everything would leak data between dealerships and roles.
Constraints	Each dealership has its own database through stancl/tenancy. Users sit at one of five role levels, from admin to employee, and should see only what their role allows. I'm the only developer and I answer the support tickets too, so it had to be simple to maintain.
Approach	I gave the model tools to call rather than putting records in the prompt. Each tool runs inside the current tenant and checks the user's permissions before it returns anything, so the model only sees what that user could open in the app.
Tradeoffs	Tools take more work than stuffing context into a prompt, and each new kind of question needs a new tool. In exchange, the access rules live in application code, and the prompt has no say in them.
Result	The assistant answers compliance questions inside the dashboard, and its answers only draw on data the user can already access.

Skills

Back end	Laravel, stancl/tenancy, Laravel Horizon, Inertia, Livewire, Filament, MySQL, SQLite, WordPress
AI	Claude API, Claude Code, AI tool use, MCP servers, Prompt engineering
Languages	PHP, TypeScript, JavaScript, Swift, Go, HTML, CSS
Front end	Vue, React, Tailwind CSS, Alpine.js
iOS	SwiftUI, SwiftData
Practice	Object-oriented PHP, MVC, Pest, Larastan, Git
Hosting and services	Laravel Cloud, Forge, Ploi, DigitalOcean, Cloudflare, Sentry, Mailgun
Media	Photography, Video
Currently learning	Python